FLEET TEAM DIGEST

737MAX-FTD-26-25001

Issue Title : Omitted Leak Checks of the Discharge Head(s) for Low Rate Discharge Cargo Fire Bottle(s)

Airplane Model	ATA	Minor Model(s)
737MAX	2623-00	-8, -8200, -9, -BBJ

Other Model(s)	ECCN
737NG, 737, 747, 767	9E991

Originated Date	Last Revised Date	Created On
05/21/2025	09/04/2026	06/22/2026

Estimated Completion Date	Next Update Date
04/30/2027	12/18/2026

Revision Description

Update Service Bulletin Completion Date and Notice of Proposed Rulemaking (NPRM) information.

Description

In 2024, Boeing discovered that the Aircraft Maintenance Manual (AMM) Low-Rate Discharge (LRD) cargo fire bottle installation tasks did not properly account for leak checks of the discharge head(s) after installation. The leakage test requirement applies to models that use bottles where alignment of the discharge head and final torque of the gland nut is necessary for installation.

It is possible that LRD cargo fire bottle discharge head leakage that is higher than allowable limits in combination with a cargo fire could result in the reduction of the duration of Halon concentration (3%) needed to suppress a cargo fire from rekindling and growing to a size which may result in the loss of Continued Safe Flight and Landing (CSF&L).

The FAA has determined this condition to be “unsafe”, and plans to issue an Airworthiness Directive (AD) to require a one-time leak check of the LRD cargo fire bottle per the updated AMM cargo fire bottle installation tasks.

Status

In September 2024, Boeing released a temporary revision (TR) to update the AMM TASK Task 26-23-01-400-801 Cargo Fire Extinguisher Bottle Installation to add SUBTASK 26-23-01-200-005, which states to “Do a leak check of the FWD and AFT discharge heads of each replaced cargo fire extinguisher bottle.” The same addition is incorporated into AMM TASK 26-23-01-400-802 Cargo Fire Extinguisher Bottle Installation - With Tool. The official AMM update was in January 2025.
In January 2026, Boeing introduced AMM TASK 26-23-01-200-801 Discharge Head Leak Check (Method 1) and AMM TASK 26-23-01-200-802 Discharge Head Leak Check (Method 2). These releases offer operators enhanced flexibility in selecting the methods for conducting discharge head leak checks following installation.

The 737 MAX Service Bulletin (SB) 737-26-1175, released on August 31, 2026, involves:

(1) ensuring an operator's maintenance program includes the Discharge Head Leak Check during the Cargo Fire Extinguisher Bottle installation procedure on the LRD Cargo Fire Extinguisher bottle(s) within 90 days of the bulletin's original issue date

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(2) one-time Discharge Head Leak Check and any necessary corrective actions on the LRD Cargo Fire Extinguisher Bottle(s) within 60 months of the bulletin's original issue date

Interim Action

Boeing released Multi Operator Message (MOM) MOM-MOM-25-0200-01B on 16-May-2025 to inform operators of the AMM update, related Task Cards, and necessary tools required to complete the leak check. Boeing recommends operators review the MOM and take action accordingly.

Final Action

Boeing has revised the AMM cargo fire bottle installation task to include a leak check of the cargo fire bottle discharge head(s) and released a Special Attention Service Bulletin (SB) 737-26-1175 to ensure the leak check is included in an operator's maintenance program and conduct a one-time leak check of the cargo fire bottle discharge head(s).

Boeing expects a FAA High Priority Notice of Proposed Rulemaking (NPRM) process, which typically involves a nine (9) month flow from NPRM to final rule, and will provide further communication once NPRM releases.

Milestones

Note: Target dates are based upon currently available status and are subject to future revision.

Update Aircraft Maintenance Manual (AMM): Oct-2024 (complete)
Service Related Problem (SRP) Acceptance: 02-Feb-2025 (complete)
Root Cause Established: 20-Mar-2025 (complete)
Solution Selection: 20-Mar-2025 (complete)
Issue Production Revision Request (PRR): 07-May-2025 (complete)
Release MOM to inform fleet of updated AMM: 16-May-2025 (complete)
Service Bulletin Available: 31-Aug-2026 (complete)

Fleet Communication Update: To be provided upon FAA NPRM release

Affected Documents

AMM TASK 26-23-01-400-801 Cargo Fire Extinguisher Bottle Installation

AMM TASK 26-23-01-400-802 Cargo Fire Extinguisher Bottle Installation - With Tool

AMM TASK 26-23-01-200-801 Discharge Head Leak Check (Method 1)

AMM TASK 26-23-01-200-802 Discharge Head Leak Check (Method 2)

Reference Categories

Reference Type	Reference Number	Revision Number	Reference Date

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Aircraft Maintenance Manual (AMM)	26-23-01-200-801		01/15/2026
Aircraft Maintenance Manual (AMM)	26-23-01-200-802		01/15/2026
Aircraft Maintenance Manual (AMM)	26-23-01-400-801		01/15/2025
Aircraft Maintenance Manual (AMM)	26-23-01-400-802		01/15/2025
Multi-Operator Message (MOM)	MOM-MOM-25-0200-01B		05/16/2025
Service Bulletin (SB)	737-26-1175		08/31/2026

Related Categories

- SRPs - Safety : Service Related Problems in work by Boeing that have an airplane or personal safety impact

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